Topic 5 — Medieval Literature

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Medieval Literature | Medieval Books and Their Authors | Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत) Literature | Sultanate and Mughal (मुग़ल) Literature | Amir Khusrau (अमीर खुसरो) | Ziauddin Barani (बरनी) | Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi | Tabaqat-i-Nasiri | Baburnama (बाबरनामा) | Akbarnama (अकबरनामा) | Ain-i-Akbari (आइन-ए-अकबरी) | Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri (तुज़ुक-ए-जहाँगीरी) | Padshahnama (पादशाहनामा) | Fatawa-i-Jahandari | Khazain-ul-Futuh | Malik Muhammad Jaisi | Padmavat (पद्मावत) | Alberuni | Badauni | Regional Persian (फ़ारसी) Chronicles

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part II*, RS Sharma *Medieval India*, UPPCS Prelims PYQs 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — book↔author NOT matched, Khusrau↔Ashiqa / Somnath↔Rag Vibodh, Babur Turki memoir, Abul Fazl chronology **Last verified:** August 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A (purely historical)

5.1 Medieval Literature — Overview

- Medieval Indian literature spans **1206–1707**, from the Delhi Sultanate through the Mughal zenith.
- **Persian** dominated as the court language from **Iltutmish to Aurangzeb**, Arabic served religious texts, and Sanskrit continued in temples.
- In the **Sultanate phase (1206–1526)**, **Minhaj, Barani, and Amir Khusrau** recorded Delhi kingdoms through political history and moral commentary.
- In the **Mughal phase (1526–1707)**, literature shifted to **imperial memoirs** (Babur, Jahangir), **official histories** (Akbarnama, Padshahnama), and **gazetteers** (Ain-i-Akbari).
- A **vernacular parallel** ran alongside Persian: Bhakti poetry (Kabir, Tulsidas, Surdas) and Sufi (सूफ़ी) Hindavi (Khusrau).
- The Mughals also launched a **translation movement**, rendering the **Mahabharata (Razmnama), Ramayana, Atharva (अथर्ववेद) Veda (वेद), and Baburnama** into Persian, peaking under **Akbar and Faizi**.
- Major **genres** include **tarikh** (annals), **tabaqat** (generational biographies), **masnavi** (long poem), **tazkira** (poet biographies), and **malfuzat** (saint conversations).
- **Gulbadan Begum** wrote *Humayunnama*, a rare female voice in Mughal prose.
- Sources such as Barani and Badauni were written with **communal and political bias**, so they must be read critically, not as neutral truth.

Logic: Book–author stems focus on **Persian chronicles and Mughal texts**; vernacular bhakti belongs in Topic 4.

> [!TIP]

Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q3]: Assertion (A): Babur wrote *Tuzk-e-Babri* in **Chagatai Turki**. Reason (R): Turki was NOT the official court language of the Mughal Empire (Mughal court language was **Persian**). *(See Q4 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

5.2 Medieval Books and Their Authors — Master Table

Book	Author	Period	Language	Type
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani	Sultanate	Persian	Tabaqat chronicle
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	Ziauddin Barani	Sultanate	Persian	Tarikh (Balban (बलबन)→Firuz)
Tughlaqnama	Ziauddin Barani	Sultanate	Persian	Tughlaq history
Fatawa-i-Jahandari	Ziauddin Barani	Sultanate	Persian	Political theory of kingship
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi (later)	Shams-i-Siraj **Afif**	Sultanate	Persian	Firuz Shah → end of Sultanate
Taj-ul-Maasir	Hasan Nizami	Sultanate	Persian	Early Delhi conquests
Khazain-ul-Futuh	Amir Khusrau	Sultanate	Persian	Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) conquests
Miftah-ul-Futuh	Amir Khusrau	Sultanate	Persian	Jalaluddin Khalji victories
Rag Vibodh	Somnath	Sultanate–early Mughal	Sanskrit	Music treatise (1609)
Khamsa	Amir Khusrau	Sultanate	Persian	Five masnavis
Kitab-ul-Hind	**Alberuni**	Ghaznavid (ग़ज़नवी)	Arabic	India under Mahmud/Ghazni
Rihla	Ibn Battuta	Sultanate	Arabic	Travelogue
Baburnama (Tuzk-e-Babri)	Babur	Mughal	**Chagatai Turki**	Memoir
Humayunnama	Gulbadan Begum	Mughal	Persian	Biography
Akbarnama	Abul Fazl	Mughal	Persian	Official narrative history
Ain-i-Akbari	Abul Fazl	Mughal	Persian	Admin gazetteer
Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri	Jahangir	Mughal	Persian	Emperor's memoir
Padshahnama	Abdul Hamid Lahori	Mughal	Persian	Shah Jahan chronicle

Book	Author	Period	Language	Type
Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh	Abdul Qadir Badauni	Mughal	Persian	Critical history
Alamgirnama	Mirza Muhammad Kazim	Mughal	Persian	Aurangzeb reign chronicle

Vernacular works:

Work	Author	Language
Chandayan	Mulla Daud	Awadhi/Hindavi
Padmavati Katha	Damodar Kavi	—
Ashiqa	Amir Khusrau	—
Padmavat	**Malik Muhammad Jaisi**	Awadhi/Hindavi
Rag Vibodh	Somnath	Sanskrit

Regional Persian chronicles:

Book	Author (fact)	Region / subject
Mirat-e-Sikandari	Sikandar ibn Muhammad (**Manjhu**)	**Gujarat** Sultanate history
Burhan-e-Masir	Sayyid (सैयद) Ali **Tabatabai**	**Bahmani** and **Ahmadnagar** (Nizam (निजाम) Shahi)
Riyaz-us-Salatin	Ghulam Husain **Salim**	**Bengal** Muslim rule
Riyaz-ul-Insha	Letters of **Mahmud Gawan**	Bahmani wazir (वज़ीर)'s state correspondence

Translation works:

Work	Translator/Author	Notes
Tutinama	Khwaja Ziya-ud-din **Nakhshabi**	Persian translation of *Suka Saptati* — **not** Amir Khusrau
Razmnama	Faizi/Naqib Khan team	Persian Mahabharata under Akbar
Ramayana (Persian)	Abdul Qadir Badauni team	Akbar's kitabkhana (किताबखाना) translation
Atharva Veda (Persian)	Akbar's translators	Part of imperial translation project
Baburnama (Persian)	Abdur Rahim (रहीम) Khan-i-Khanan	Translated Babur's Turki memoir
Rajatarangini (राजतरंगिणी) (Persian)	Ziauddin **Nakhshabi**	Early Sultanate Sanskrit→Persian translation

5.3 Delhi Sultanate Literature

- Turkish and Afghan sultans patronised **Persian** as the state language, and chronicles legitimised **new Muslim rulers** in an Indian context.
- **Minhaj-us-Siraj** wrote **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri**, covering the **Ghaznavids to Nasiruddin Mahmud** (~1260); **tabaqat** means a generational or class format, and the work is named after patron Sultan **Nasiruddin Mahmud**.
- **Hasan Nizami** wrote **Taj-ul-Maasir**, covering **Qutb-ud-din Aibak to Iltutmish**, the earliest Delhi conquest narrative.
- **Ziauddin Barani** was a privileged Delhi court insider who wrote for **Firuz Shah Tughlaq** and is a primary source on **Alauddin Khalji's** reforms.
- **Amir Khusrau** was a poet-musician at the courts of **Balban, Alauddin, and Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**, a Hindavi pioneer, and a disciple of **Nizamuddin Auliya**.
- **Ibn Battuta's Rihla** records his stay at **Muhammad bin Tughlaq (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक)'s** court (~1334–1341) as an eyewitness travel account; he did **not** write Tughlaqnama.
- Sufi prose includes *Fawaid-ul-Fuad* (Nizamuddin conversations), compiled by **Amir Hasan Sijzi**, linking literature to Sufi religion.
- **Firuz Shah** collected Sanskrit books from **Nagarkot** and encouraged translations, creating a parallel track to Persian chronicles.

> **Logic: Tughlaqnama–Ibn Battuta** is **wrong** — **Barani** wrote **Tughlaqnama**. **Tarikh-i-Firozshahi–Shams-i-Siraj Alif** is also wrong; **Barani** wrote the standard **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q16]:** *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* = Minhaj-us-Siraj; *Tarikh-i-Firozshahi* = Shams-i Siraj Afif & Ziauddin Barani; *Tughlaqnama* = **Amir Khusrau** (NOT Ibn Battuta); *Humayun-nama* = Gulbadan Begum. *(See Q1 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

5.4 Sultanate and Mughal Literature — Transition

- Both periods used **Persian** as the primary literary language, except for Babur's Turki memoir.
- **Baburnama** introduced a frank autobiographical style covering gardens, wine, battles, and feelings.
- **Ain-i-Akbari** broke new ground as an imperial gazetteer that catalogued the empire as data on revenue, castes, animals, and customs, rather than as narrative history.
- Akbar's **kitabkhana** (किताबखाना) produced **Razmnama, a Persian Ramayana, and a Persian Atharva Veda**, exceeding Firuz Shah's translation efforts.
- **Gulbadan Begum** (Babur's daughter) wrote *Humayunnama*, a voice absent from Sultanate chronicles.
- **Badauni** wrote a secret critique of Akbar's liberal policies while serving at court, marking critical historiography.

- Under **Shah Jahan** (शाहजहाँ), formal court chronicle returned through **Padshahnama** after Jahangir's intimate memoir style.
- Under **Aurangzeb**, literary patronage declined, regional vernaculars rose, and **Alamgirnama** continued the chronicle tradition.

5.5 Amir Khusrau (1253–1325)

Period: Delhi Sultanate | **Guru (गुरु):** Nizamuddin Auliya | **Buried:** Near Nizamuddin Dargah, Delhi

- Amir Khusrau served the courts of **Balban, Alauddin Khalji, and Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** and died in **1325**, about **200 years before Akbar**.
- **Khamsa** is a set of five Persian masnavis modeled on Nizami, including **Matla-ul-Anwar** and **Khusrau-o-Shirin**.
- **Nuh Sipihr (Nine Skies)** praises **India's climate, languages, and culture**, showing pride in Hindustan.
- **Khaliq-e-Bari** contains early **Hindavi** devotional verses and marks the Hindi-Urdu literary synthesis.
- **Ashiqa** (Deval Rani Khizr Khan) is Khusrau's romantic historical masnavi; **Rag Vibodh** is **Somnath's** Sanskrit music treatise (1609), not Khusrau's.
- **Miftah-ul-Futuh** records **Jalaluddin Khalji's** victories.
- **Khazain-ul-Futuh** is Khusrau's Persian prose account of **Alauddin Khalji's** conquests and administration.
- Khusrau created **Sabak-i-Hind** (Indian style) in Persian poetry and called himself **Tuti-e-Hind** (Parrot of India).
- He was born at **Patiyali (Etah, UP)** — a direct UPPCS regional fact.
- Khusrau's **Tughluq Nama** is a **poem** on Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq, distinct from Barani's prose **Tughlaqnama**.
- Folklore attributes **sitar, tabla (तबला), qawwali (क़व्वाली), and tarana (तराना)** to Khusrau, and papers accept his pioneer status.
- Khusrau was **not Mughal**: he is not Tansen (Akbar's court), and he did not translate **Tutinama** — that was **Nakhshabi**.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q43]: Zia Nakhshabi** was the first to translate Sanskrit stories into Persian (*Tutinama*, based on Chintamani Bhatt's *Shukasaptati*). *(See Q6 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q43) Who translated *Suka Saptati* into Persian as *Tutinama*?

A. Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi B. Abdur Razzak C. Shihabuddin-al-Umari D. Amir Khusrau

Show answer

Correct Answer: **A** (Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi) **Detailed Explanation:** - **Option A is correct:** Khwaja Ziya-ud-din Nakhshabi (a 14th-century Persian physician and Sufi scholar living in Badaun, UP, during the reign of Muhammad bin Tughlaq) translated the ancient Sanskrit story collection *Suka Saptati* ("Seventy Tales of the Parrot") into Persian under the title **Tutinama** (*Book of the Parrot*) in 1329–30 CE. The work consists of 52 moral and romantic tales narrated by a wise parrot to prevent its mistress Khojasta from committing adultery while her husband is away. It was later lavishly illustrated in 250 miniature paintings under Emperor Akbar. - **Option B is incorrect:** Kamaluddin Abdur Razzak Samarqandi was a Persian envoy of Timurid ruler Shahrukh who visited the Vijayanagara Empire (reign of Deva Raya II) in 1443 CE and left a famous travel account. - **Option C is incorrect:** Shihabuddin al-Umari was a 14th-century Arab geographer and encyclopedist of Damascus who wrote *Masalik al-Absar fi Mamalik al-Amsar*, describing Muhammad bin Tughlaq's empire based on traveler reports. - **Option D is incorrect:** Amir Khusrau was a prolific poet (*Khazain-ul-Futuh*, *Ashiqa*, *Nuh Sipihr*, *Qiran-us-Sa'dain*), but he did not translate *Suka Saptati* into *Tutinama*. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - *Distractor Alert:* Amir Khusrau (*Tuti-e-Hind* / "Parrot of India") is frequently set as a distractor for *Tutinama* ("Book of the Parrot"). Remember: **Nakhshabi** translated *Tutinama*.

5.6 Ziauddin Barani (1285–1357)

Period: Delhi Sultanate | **Role:** Noble insider historian | **Patron:** Firuz Shah Tughlaq

- **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** covers **Balban to early Firuz Shah** and is the primary source on **Alauddin Khalji's** market reforms, military system, and policies.
- **Tughlaqnama** is a dedicated study of the **Tughlaq dynasty**, analysing **Muhammad bin Tughlaq's** token currency (सांकेतिक मुद्रा) and Daulatabad transfer.
- **Fatawa-i-Jahandari** is Barani's **political treatise** on kingship (**jahandari** = worldly rule), not a narrative chronicle — do not confuse with **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**.
- Barani's **Jahandari theory** treats the Sultanate as a **worldly state** balancing Sharia and political realism; **zawabit** (state laws) can override narrow Sharia.
- Barani was **biased**, hostile to the **low-born Khalji rise**, and used a communal tone about Hindus, so his work must be read critically.
- **Tughlaqnama–Ibn Battuta** is **wrong**, and **Tarikh-i-Firozshahi–Shams-i-Siraj Alif** is also **wrong** — the correct author is **Barani**.

> **Logic:** Barani wrote both **Tughlaqnama** and **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**; memorise them as a single-author two-book pair.

5.7 Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi & Tabaqat-i-Nasiri

Feature	Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi
Author	Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani	Ziauddin Barani

Feature	Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi
Period	Ghurid (गौर) → ~1260	Balban → Firuz Shah
Format	Tabaqat (generational classes)	Tarikh (annals)
Patron	Nasiruddin Mahmud	Firuz Shah Tughlaq

- **Minhaj** came from the **Ghazni tradition** and wrote the earliest major Delhi Sultanate chronicle.
- **Barani** is an eyewitness source for the mature Sultanate and is key for **Alauddin** administration questions (Topic 2 overlap).
- Do not confuse **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri** (Minhaj) with **Tabaqat-i-Akbari**, which is a Mughal-period work.

Barani vs Afif — two Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi

Author	Work	Coverage
Ziauddin Barani	**Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**	**Balban** (बलबन) → early **Firuz Shah Tughlaq**
Shams-i-Siraj Afif	**Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi**	**Firuz Shah → end of Delhi Sultanate**

- Pairing **Tarikh-i-Firozshahi** with **Shams-i-Siraj Afif** is **wrong** for Barani's standard chronicle — though Afif did write a later work with the same title.
- Key fact: when the option says **Barani**, choose Barani; when it says **Afif**, that is a deliberate distractor for Barani's book.

5.8 Baburnama (Tuzk-e-Babri)

Author: Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur | **Original language:Chagatai Turki** | **Also called:** Tuzk-e-Babri, Tuzuk-i-Baburi (तुजुक-ए-बाबरी)

- **Baburnama** ranks among the world's great **royal memoirs** and is candid about battles, gardens, wine, poetry, and Indian flora (वनस्पति) and fauna (प्राणीजात).
- **Baburnama** was written in **Chagatai Turki** (A true), but **Persian** — not Turki — was the Mughal court language (R false).
- **Persian** became the Mughal court language, while Babur's Turki remained his personal literary idiom only.
- The memoir covers **Central Asian struggles**, the **First Panipat (पानीपत) (1526)**, and observations on Indian climate and nature.
- **Abdur Rahim Khan-i-Khanan** later translated Baburnama into **Persian** for wider court access.
- Baburnama was the first major **intimate royal autobiography** in the Indian Muslim tradition and precedes Jahangir's Tuzuk.

5.9 Akbarnama & Ain-i-Akbari (Abul Fazl)

Author: Abul Fazl (1551–1602) | **Role:** Akbar's Navratna; chief ideologue of **sulh-i-kul** (सुलह-ए-कुल)

	Akbarnama	Ain-i-Akbari
Type	Narrative history (3 volumes)	Administrative gazetteer
Focus	Akbar's life, campaigns, policies	Revenue, army (सेना), provinces, society data
Trap	Called "gazetteer" = wrong	Called "biography" = wrong

- **Abul Fazl's family** included his brother **Faizi** (फैजी) (poet) and his father **Sheikh Mubarak** (scholar).
- **Akbarnama** paintings are major Mughal art examples, and **Badauni's Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh** is the hostile counter-narrative written secretly.
- Court death order: **Faizi (1595)** → **Sheikh Mubarak (1597)** → **Abul Fazl murdered (1602)** → **Daniyal (1604)**.
- Abul Fazl was murdered by **Bir Singh Bundela**, an ally of Jahangir, in 1602.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q132]:** Chronology of deaths in Akbar's court circle: **Faizi (1595)** → **Abul Fazl (1602, murdered by Bir Singh Bundela on Jahangir's orders)** → **Akbar (1605)**. *(See Q3 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

5.10 Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri

Author: Jahangir himself | **Language:Persian** | **Also called:** Jahangirnama

- **Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri** continues the memoir tradition of **Baburnama** but was written in Persian, not Turki.
- It records **court life, wine, executions, art patronage, and natural history**, including zebras, birds, and flowers.
- Politically it notes **Guru Arjan (गुरु अर्जन)'s execution**, **Khurram's rebellion**, and **Nur Jahan (नूरजहाँ)'s** influence.
- **Babur** wrote a Turki founder memoir, **Jahangir** wrote a Persian consolidator memoir, and **Abul Fazl's Akbarnama** is third-person official history.
- Some parts were edited or completed after Jahangir's death but are still attributed to him.

5.11 Padshahnama

Emperor: Shah Jahan | **Primary author:** Abdul Hamid Lahori | **Language:** Persian

- **Padshahnama** is the official **court chronicle** of Shah Jahan's reign and restores formal panegyric style after Jahangir's intimate memoir.
- Lahori completed the **first two volumes** (~1627–1648), and **Inayat Khan** added the later portion.
- It covers **accession, Deccan (दक्कन) campaigns, the Taj Mahal (ताज महल) context**, court ceremonies, and Dara (दारा) Shukoh–Aurangzeb tensions.
- **Padshahnama illustrations** form a major Mughal painting commission.
- Do not confuse Padshahnama with Akbar (Abul Fazl) or Jahangir (Tuzuk).

5.12 Regional Persian Chronicles

Weight: ★★★ — Regional Persian histories (Gujarat, Ahmadnagar, Bengal, Gawan's letters) recur in match-list stems.

List-I (Book)	List-II (Context)	Author cue
Mirat-e-Sikandari	**Gujarat** Sultanate / Muzaffar Shah victory (4)	Sikandar ibn Muhammad (**Manjhu**)
Burhan-e-Masir	**Bahmani** and **Ahmadnagar** (Nizam Shahi) history (2)	Sayyid Ali **Tabatabai**
Riyaz-us-Salatin	**Bengal** Muslim rule (1)	Ghulam Husain **Salim**
Riyaz-ul-Insha	**Mahmud Gawan's** official letters (3)	Compiled from Bahmani wazir's correspondence

- **Mirat-e-Sikandari** describes the **Gujarat Sultanate** and the establishment of Muzaffar Shah's kingdom — not Delhi Sultanate history.
- **Burhan-e-Masir** ("Proof of Destiny") covers the **Deccan** (दक्कन): **Bahmani** sultans and **Ahmadnagar** under the Nizam Shahi line.
- **Riyaz-us-Salatin** is a **Bengal** chronicle from early Muslim rule through later periods — do not confuse with Gawan's letters.
- **Riyaz-ul-Insha** preserves **Mahmud Gawan's** diplomatic and administrative letters — the best primary source on his reforms at the Bahmani court.
- The two **Riyaz** titles are the classic swap trap: **-us-Salatin** = Bengal history; **-ul-Insha** = Gawan's letters.

> **Logic: Mirat-e-Sikandari** narrates the **Gujarat** victory; **Burhan-e-Masir** covers **Ahmadnagar**; **Riyaz-us-Salatin** is **Bengal** history; **Riyaz-ul-Insha** collects **Gawan's** letters.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q33]:** Regional chronicles: *Mirat-e-Sikandari* = Gujarat; *Burhan-e-Masir* = Ahmadnagar; *Riyaz-us-Salatin* = Bengal; *Tazkirat-ul-Muluk* = Bijapur. *(See Q7 in Complete PYQ Bank below)*

5.13 Supplementary Works — Alberuni, Jaisi, Badauni, Isami

Extra book–author facts beyond the main Sultanate and Mughal tables — often tested as traps.

Quick learn table (read this first)

Who	Book	Language	One-line fact
Alberuni	**Kitab-ul-Hind**	Arabic	India under **Mahmud of Ghazni** — science, religion, society
Malik Muhammad Jaisi	**Padmavat**	Awadhi	Sufi romance of **Padmini / Ratan Sen** (~16th c.)
Mulla Daud	**Chandayan**	Awadhi/Hindavi	Early vernacular love romance (same stream as Jaisi)
Abdul Qadir Badauni	**Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh**	Persian	Secret **anti-Akbar** history written at court
Abdul Malik Isami	**Futuh-us-Salatin**	Persian	**Bahmani / Deccan** history
Mirza Muhammad Kazim	**Alamgirnama**	Persian	**Aurangzeb** reign chronicle
Firuz Shah Tughlaq	**Fatwa-i-Firuz Shahi**	Persian	Sultan's own rules — **not** Barani's Fatawa-i-Jahandari

5.13.1 Alberuni — Arabic & early Indic contact

Al-Biruni (Alberuni) | Kitab-ul-Hind / Tahqiq-i-Hind | Arabic | Ghaznavid era

- **Alberuni** wrote **Kitab-ul-Hind (Tahqiq-i-Hind)** in **Arabic**.
- He was born in **973 CE** at **Khiva (Khwarizm)** and came to India with **Mahmud of Ghazni** in the **11th century**.
- He was the **first Muslim to study the Puranas** and used Sanskrit works of **Brahmagupta**, **Balabhadra**, and **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर).
- The book is a **scientific, comparative** account of Indian **religion, astronomy, and society**.
- **Edward Sachau** translated it into English.
- It belongs to the **Ghaznavid era** — an early medieval (प्रारंभिक मध्यकाल) source.

- It is **not** a Delhi Sultanate court chronicle like Barani or Minhaj.
- Do **not** confuse him with **Firdausi** (फिरदौसी) (**Shahnama**) or later **Firishta** (फरिश्ता).

> **Key fact: Kitab-ul-Hind = Alberuni + Arabic + Ghazni** — not Khusrau, not Barani.

5.13.2 Vernacular Awadhi line (UP angle)

Awadhi/Hindavi | North Indian vernacular | parallel to Persian court literature

Malik Muhammad Jaisi — Padmavat

- **Malik Muhammad Jaisi** composed **Padmavat** in **Awadhi** (~16th century).
- It is a **Sufi-influenced romance** of **Padmini and Ratan Sen**.
- This is highly **UP-relevant** Awadhi literature.

Mulla Daud — Chandayan

- **Mulla Daud's Chandayan** is an early **Awadhi/Hindavi** love romance.
- It belongs to the **same vernacular stream** as Jaisi's **Padmavat**.

Trap — two different "Padma (पद्मा)" books

Book	Author	Remember
Padmavat	**Malik Muhammad Jaisi**	Awadhi epic; UP fact
Padmavati Katha	**Damodar Kavi**	Appears in vernacular book–author match lists

- **Padmavat** (Jaisi) is **not** the same as **Padmavati Katha** (Damodar Kavi) — a common title trap.

5.13.3 Badauni — critical counter-history

Abdul Qadir Badauni | Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh | Secret critic at Akbar's court

- **Badauni** secretly wrote **Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh** while still serving at Akbar's court.
- In it he attacked Akbar's **liberal policies**, **sulh-i-kul**, and **translation projects**.
- At the same time he **led the Persian Ramayana translation** team in Akbar's **kitabkhana**.
- So Badauni did **official translation work** but wrote **private hostile history**.

Badauni vs Abul Fazl — pair correctly

Historian	Attitude	Main works
Abdul Qadir Badauni	**Hostile** / critical	**Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh**
Abul Fazl	**Official** / panegyric	**Akbarnama**, **Ain-i-Akbari**

- Pair **Badauni** with **hostile historiography**.
- Pair **Abul Fazl** with official **Akbarnama** and **Ain-i-Akbari**.

5.13.4 Other coaching-map facts

Book	Author	Fact
Futuh-us-Salatin	**Abdul Malik Isami**	Bahmani / Deccan history
Alamgirnama	Mirza Muhammad Kazim	**Aurangzeb** reign chronicle
Fatwa-i-Firuz Shahi	**Firuz Shah Tughlaq**	Sultan's own regulations — not Barani's **Fatawa-i-Jahandari**